Current Affairs 15-10-2026

Credit - Drishti Ias

Black Sea Attacks Renew Focus on Seafarer Safety

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Source: DD News

The **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) condemned attacks on three commercial vessels in the Black Sea** - **Alfa Watan (Togo), MV Able (Palau) and Aframax Rio (Liberia)** . Of the 18 crew members aboard MV Able, seven were Indian nationals

- With India accounting for around 12% of the global seafaring workforce, protecting Indian seafarers is a critical concern.
- **About Black Sea:** The **Black Sea is a large inland sea situated in southeastern Europe,** bordered by Ukraine to the north, Russia to the northeast, Georgia to the east, Turkey to the south, and Bulgaria and Romania to the west.
  - It connects to the **Mediterranean Sea** through the **Bosporus Strait, Sea of Marmara and Dardanelles, while the Kerch Strait links it to the Sea of Azov.**
  - Its deep waters below approximately 70–150 metres are largely devoid of oxygen and contain hydrogen sulphide, creating a unique marine dead zone.
  - The Black Sea is strategically and economically significant as a major maritime trade route, supporting petroleum transportation, fisheries and tourism.
  - Its major ports include **Odesa (Ukraine), Novorossiysk (Russia), Batumi (Georgia), Varna (Bulgaria) and Constanța (Romania).**
  - The Bucharest Convention (1992) provides a regional framework for controlling marine pollution and protecting the Black Sea ecosystem.



Read More: Black Sea

Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC)

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Source: PIB

Why in News?

The **Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)** highlighted the growing role of Khadi and Village Industries in transforming traditional skills and local resources into modern rural enterprises through access to finance, technology and training, with the **Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC)** at the centre of this transformation.

- The Khadi Mahotsav, organised annually from 2nd to 31st October, complements these efforts by promoting Khadi and local products, raising awareness among youth, and encouraging public participation in the **Vocal for Local** and **Atmanirbhar Bharat** initiatives.

What are the Key Facts About Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC)?

- **About:** The **Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) i** s a statutory body under the **Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME),** established under the **Khadi and Village Industries Commission Act, 1956.**
- **Objective:** To promote rural industrialisation, generate employment, strengthen village industries and support artisans through financial, technical and marketing assistance.



Initiatives for Market Promotion

- **International Market Linkages:** KVIC facilitates participation in international exhibitions and trade fairs, helping **rural enterprises connect with overseas buyers** and expand their export opportunities.
- **Digital Market Access:** KVIC operates the **Khadi India online store** , offering products such as clothing and fabrics, groceries, beauty products, essential oils, perfumes and incense sticks.
- **Retail Network:** The Khadi marketing network includes **8 departmental Khadi India sales outlets, 15 KVIC branches and 8,035 sales outlets operated by Khadi Institutions** across the country.
- **Global Khadi:** Khadi is increasingly being presented through contemporary fashion platforms, including **New Zealand Fashion Week 2026 and Lakmé Fashion Week 2025** , where traditional craftsmanship has been combined with modern designs.

Major Achievements of KVIC

- **Sectoral Growth:** In **2025–26** , sales of Khadi and Village Industries products reached a record **₹1.87 lakh crore** , while production increased by **380% to ₹1,25,296 crore** compared with 2013–14.
- **Employment Generation:** Employment in the sector increased by 56% to 2.04 crore between 2013–14 and 2025–26, highlighting the sector’s role in rural employment.
- **Training and Skill Development:** KVIC operates 35 departmental and non-departmental training centres offering training in activities such as food processing, bakery, beekeeping, agarbatti and candle making, and motor repairing. During FY 2025–26, 79,682 individuals received training, including 47,382 women (approximately 59%).
- **Women’s Participation:** Women constitute more than **80% of approximately five lakh artisans** in the Khadi sector, highlighting its importance for women’s economic participation.

What are the Major Schemes Associated with KVIC?

- **PMEGP Employment:** Since March 2008, the **Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP)** has provided employment opportunities to nearly **97.95 lakh people through KVIC** .
- **Gramodyog Vikas Yojana:** The **Gramodyog Vikas Yojana (GVY)** supports artisans by providing modern machines, toolkits and equipment, with **37,769 machines, toolkits and equipment distributed during 2025–26** and more than **3.23 lakh distributed by May 2026** .
- **Khadi Vikas Yojana:** The scheme supports Khadi institutions through product improvement, value addition and market development. Its **Modified Market Development Assistance (MMDA)** component provides flexibility for value addition and market-oriented pricing. In 2024–25, the scheme disbursed ₹245 crore to 1,097 Khadi institutions, benefiting 1,45,484 artisans.
- **Concessional Credit:** Under the **Interest Subsidy Eligibility Certificate Scheme** , eligible Khadi institutions can access credit at a concessional interest rate of **4% per annum** .
- **Workshed Support:** The **Workshed Scheme** provides improved production spaces and better working conditions for artisans.

Conclusion

The transformation of Khadi and Village Industries into **market-oriented rural enterprises** highlights the importance of integrating traditional skills with **modern technology, financial support and market access.** Strengthening this ecosystem can promote inclusive rural development, women's economic empowerment, sustainable livelihoods and **self-reliance in line with the vision of Atmanirbhar Bharat.**

Drishti Mains Practice Questions

Khadi and Village Industries can serve as an important bridge between India's traditional knowledge and modern rural entrepreneurship. Discuss.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is Khadi?
Khadi is a hand-spun and hand-woven textile associated with India's traditional rural production system and the country's self-reliance movement.

2. What is the Khadi and Village Industries Commission?
The **Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC)** is a statutory body established under the **Khadi and Village Industries Commission Act, 1956** .

3. What are the major functions of KVIC?
Its major functions include **training, provision of raw materials, marketing support, research, quality improvement, skill development and technical support** for Khadi and village industries.

4. What is Khadi Mahotsav?
Khadi Mahotsav is an annual campaign organised from **2 October to 31 October** to promote Khadi, local products and the **Vocal for Local** approach, particularly among youth.

5. How do Khadi and Village Industries contribute to rural employment?
The sector generates employment through diverse activities such as **textiles, food processing, beekeeping, agarbatti production, handicrafts and other village industries** , thereby creating livelihood opportunities in rural areas.

[Watch Video on YouTube: ▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/fX6D_p8tJR4]

UPSC Civil Services Examination Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Mains

Q. Smart cities in India cannot sustain without smart villages. Discuss this statement in the backdrop of rural-urban integration. **(2015)**

Starlink and Satellite Internet

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Source: TH

Why in News?

A public dispute over **Starlink's proposed entry into India's satellite internet market** has

raised concerns regarding **market competition, regulatory approvals, national security and consumer affordability** , highlighting the challenges surrounding the expansion of satellite-based internet services in India.

What are the Key Facts About Starlink?

- **About Starlink:** **Starlink** is a **satellite-based broadband internet service** developed by **SpaceX.** It uses a constellation of **Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellites** to provide high-speed, low-latency internet connectivity, particularly in remote and underserved regions.
- **Satellite Constellation:** Starlink operates the **world's largest commercial satellite constellation,** with approximately **11,000 satellites in orbit as of October 2026** , primarily operating at altitudes of around **550 km, compared to 35,786 km** for geostationary satellites.
- **Advanced Technology:** Starlink satellites use **optical inter-satellite links (space lasers),** phased-array antennas and argon-powered ion thrusters to enable high-speed data transmission, satellite-to-satellite communication and orbital manoeuvring.
- **Low-Latency Connectivity:** Starlink offers latency of around **25 milliseconds under favourable conditions** , compared with approximately **600 milliseconds** or more for traditional geostationary satellite internet, supporting video calls, online gaming and streaming.
- **SpaceX Integration:** SpaceX manufactures and operates **Starlink satellites** and uses its **Falcon 9 launch** vehicles to regularly deploy and upgrade the constellation, supporting continuous network expansion.
- **Strategic and Humanitarian Applications:** Starlink provides connectivity in remote areas, disaster-affected regions and conflict zones where terrestrial communication networks are unavailable, damaged or disrupted.
- **Military Applications:** SpaceX has also developed **Starshield** , a separate military-focused satellite communications programme for US government and national security applications.

What is the Status of Starlink's Licence in India?

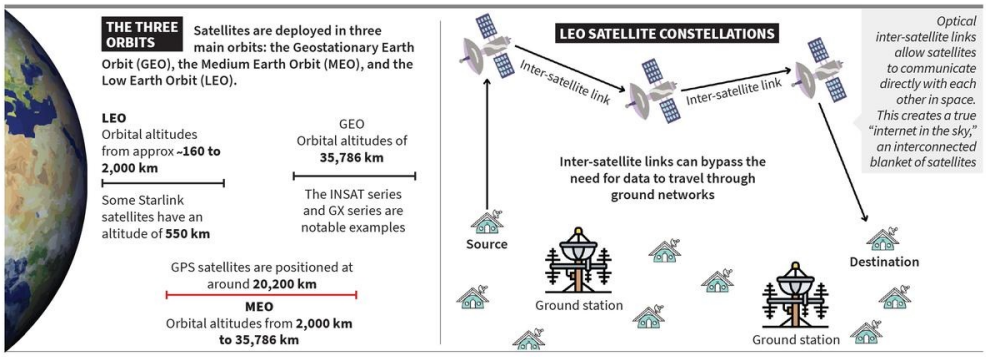
- **GMPCS Licence:** Starlink received a Unified Licence with **Global Mobile Personal Communication by Satellite (GMPCS)** authorisation from the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) in June 2025, permitting satellite communication services subject to regulatory conditions.
- **IN-SPACe Authorisation:** In July 2025, Starlink also received authorisation from the **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)** for its satellite constellation.
- **Pending Clearances:** Despite these approvals, Starlink has not commenced commercial services in India, as final security clearances, spectrum assignment and other regulatory requirements remain pending.
- **Commercial Partnerships:** In March 2025, SpaceX signed separate agreements with **Jio Platforms and Bharti Airtel** to explore distributing Starlink services in India, subject to the necessary regulatory approvals.
- **Current Status:** Starlink holds key telecommunications and space-sector authorisations but cannot launch commercial satellite internet services in India until **the remaining security and spectrum-related** requirements are fulfilled.

How Does Satellite Internet Work?

- **About:** Satellite internet is a communication technology that uses **orbiting satellites to provide broadband connectivity,** particularly in remote, sparsely populated and disaster-prone regions where terrestrial networks are economically unviable or unavailable.
- **Working Mechanism:** Satellite internet operates through **two main segments:**
  - **Space Segment:** Consists of satellites equipped with communication payloads that receive, process or relay data signals between **Earth-based terminals and ground stations.**
  - **Ground Segment:** Comprises user terminals (antennas and modems) and ground stations that communicate with satellites and connect users to the internet backbone.
- **Orbital Deployment:** Communication satellites are deployed in **three main orbital regions:**
  - **Geostationary Earth Orbit (GEO):** Located approximately 35,786 km above the equator, **GEO satellites** remain stationary relative to Earth and provide extensive coverage, but their high latency limits performance in time-sensitive applications. Example: **Inmarsat Global Xpress (GX).**
  - **Medium Earth Orbit (MEO):** Located between approximately 2,000 km and 35,786 km, MEO satellites offer lower latency than GEO satellites but require constellations for wider coverage. **Example: O3b constellation.**
  - **Low Earth Orbit (LEO):** Located below 2,000 km, LEO satellites provide **low-latency connectivity** but have smaller individual coverage areas, requiring large constellations for continuous coverage. **Example: Starlink.**
- **Mega-Constellation Technology:** Advanced LEO constellations use **onboard signal processing, phased-array antennas** and optical inter-satellite links (space lasers) to enable direct satellite-to-satellite communication, efficient data routing and seamless connectivity as satellites move across the

sky.

- **Applications:** Satellite internet supports connectivity in remote regions, **disaster management, telemedicine , precision agriculture ,** maritime and aviation communications, military operations and emergency response.
- **Challenges:** Despite its advantages, satellite internet faces challenges such as high equipment and **subscription costs, orbital congestion, space debris, cybersecurity risks** and national security concerns associated with its dual-use civilian and military applications.



Frequently Asked Questions(FAQs)

1. What is Starlink?
Starlink is a satellite-based broadband internet service developed by SpaceX, founded by Elon Musk. It uses a constellation of Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellites to provide high-speed, low-latency internet connectivity, particularly in remote and underserved regions.

2. Why is Starlink in the news in India?
Starlink has attracted attention following a public dispute between Elon Musk and Mukesh Ambani over competition and regulatory barriers in India's satellite internet market, raising concerns about market access, national security and consumer affordability.

3. Has Starlink received permission to operate in India?
Starlink has received GMPCS authorisation from the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) and authorisation from IN-SPACe. However, commercial services have not commenced because additional security requirements and spectrum assignment remain pending.

4. What is GMPCS authorisation?
Global Mobile Personal Communication by Satellite (GMPCS) authorisation permits operators to provide satellite-based communication services in India, subject to prescribed licensing, security and regulatory conditions.

5. What is the role of IN-SPACe in satellite internet services?
The Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe) is responsible for authorising and facilitating non-government space activities, including the operation of satellite constellations serving India.

[Watch Video on YouTube: ▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/J6OFKclvA3o]

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims :

Q. For the measurement/estimation of which of the following are satellite images/remote

sensing data used? (2019)

1. Chlorophyll content in the vegetation of a specific location
2. Greenhouse gas emissions from rice paddies of a specific location
3. Land surface temperatures of a specific location

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans: (d)

Q. With reference to India's satellite launch vehicles, consider the following statements: (2018)

1. PSLVs launch the satellites useful for Earth resources monitoring whereas GSLVs are designed mainly to launch communication satellites.
2. Satellites launched by PSLV appear to remain permanently fixed in the same position in the sky, as viewed from a particular location on Earth.
3. GSLV Mk III is a four-staged launch vehicle with the first and third stages using solid rocket motors, and the second and fourth stages using liquid rocket engines.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 and 3

(c) 1 and 2

(d) 3 only

Ans: (a)

Q. With reference to Web 3-0, consider the following statements: (2022)

1. Web 3.0 technology enables people to control their own data.
2. In Web 3.0 world, there can be blockchain based social networks.
3. Web 3.0 is operated by users collectively rather than a corporation.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans: (d)

Mains

Q. Discuss India's achievements in the field of Space Science and Technology. How the application of this technology helped India in its socio-economic development? **(2016)**

Q. Has digital illiteracy, particularly in rural areas, coupled with lack of Information and Communication Technology(ICT) accessibility hindered socio-economic development? Examine with justification. **(2021)**

India’s First Cyber Trojan Horse Unveiled in Kochi

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Source: TH

India’s first **Cyber Trojan Horse** , called **The Trojan Project** , was unveiled at the **c0c0n 2026** cybersecurity conference in **Kochi** . The project aims to make **cyber risks easier to understand** and **promote safer behaviour** in the digital world.

- **About c0c0n 2026: Organised by Kerala Police Cyberdome** and the **Information Security Research Association (ISRA).**
  - ISRA is a **registered scientific society** under the Cochin Literary Scientific and Charitable Societies Registration Act 1955.
  - It is dedicated to **advancing security research** and fostering an innovation ecosystem in the field of information security.
- **Trojan:** In cybersecurity, a **Trojan** is **malicious software** disguised as a legitimate file or application to **enter a device and steal data.**
  - The term **'Trojan horse'** first appeared in professional literature in **James Anderson's study (1972).**
  - It requires **human interaction (user downloading/opening the file) to install and execute.**
  - Unlike **Viruses (which attach to files and replicate) or Worms (which self-replicate autonomously across networks)** , Trojans do not replicate themselves.



Read More: **Strengthening India’s Cyber Security Architecture**

India–Czech to Expand Defence-Industrial Ties

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Source: DD India

India and the Czech Republic agreed to expand defence-industrial cooperation during Indian Defence Minister meeting with Czech First Deputy Prime Minister in New Delhi.

- The bilateral **MoU on Defence Cooperation** was signed in **October 2003** , leading to the establishment of the **India–Czech Joint Defence Committee (JDC)** .
  - The **7th JDC meeting** was held in **Prague in October 2025** , after a five-year gap.
  - Building on this momentum, the **October 2026 ministerial meeting** agreed to further expand defence-industrial cooperation through the JDC framework.
  - The partnership promotes joint ventures, co-production and technology collaboration, supporting **Make in India** and **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** .
- **About Czech Republic:** The **Czech Republic is a Central European country with Prague as its capital** .
  - It is a member of both the **European Union (EU) and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO).**
- **India-Czech Republic Relations:**
  - **Historical Ties:** India's links with the Czech lands date back to medieval trade with the **Kingdom of Bohemia** .
    - Diplomatic relations with Czechoslovakia began in **1947** ;
    - India recognised the Czech Republic after Czechoslovakia's dissolution in **1993** .
  - **Economic Partnership:** Bilateral trade reached **US$ 4.034 billion in 2025** . India exports electronics, pharmaceuticals, textiles and engineering goods, while importing machinery, automobile components and industrial equipment.
  - **Multilateral Support:** The Czech Republic supports India's bid for **permanent membership of a reformed UN Security Council** and its full membership of the **Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG)** .



Read More: India - European Relations - Drishti IAS

Chhattisgarh Launches Blackbuck Translocation Initiative

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Source: IE

Chhattisgarh will translocate **50 blackbucks from Barnawapara Wildlife Sanctuary to Gomarda Wildlife Sanctuary,** where the species became locally extinct in the 1970s due to hunting, poaching, encroachment and development.

- **Barnawapara Sanctuary:** Located in Chhattisgarh, it has undulating terrain, low hillocks and teak, sal and mixed forests.
  - The **Balamdehi** forms its western boundary, while the **Jonk River** lies along its north-eastern side; both are tributaries of the Mahanadi.
  - Barnawapara is known for **gaur, chital, sambar, nilgai and wild boar.** Its successful blackbuck population is now the source for the Gomarda reintroduction.
- **Gomarda Sanctuary:** Located near **Sarangarh in Chhattisgarh,** Gomarda has dry deciduous forests, rolling hills, grasslands, reservoirs and waterfalls, features favourable for blackbuck restoration.
- **Blackbuck:** The blackbuck **(*Antilope cervicapra*)** is a diurnal, grassland antelope; males have

distinctive spiral horns and a dark upper body.

- It **is native to the Indian subcontinent** and prefers open grasslands and plains. It is primarily a grazer, but browses when grass is scarce.
- It has a **gestation period of about six months** and can breed throughout the year.
- **Conservation Threats:** Habitat loss, hunting and disturbance remain key threats. Fawns are particularly vulnerable to predation by free-ranging dogs and jackals **.**
- **Legal Protection:** It receives the highest level of protection under **Schedule I of the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972** .



Read More: **Blackbuck Revival in Chattishgarh - Drishti IAS**